Sri Kumar was leading the team to Bangalore. Within hours they had identified the hideout based on Vicky's rough description. It was located in Bangalore's posh residential area, Indira Nagar. Inquiries made with the neighbours confirmed the occasional presence of a green Maruti Gypsy and a blue Premier Padmini car outside the house, in a clear indication of the political group operating from there. Trichy had been using those cars. The house was immediately put under round-the-clock surveillance. Sri Kumar made sure the team worked with extra caution. Even the slightest mistake could alert the suspects and they would bite the cyanide pill. There was no sign of life from the house. All its doors and windows were shut and no movement was noticed. After an entire day passed, suddenly there was light from inside, negating the SIT's initial apprehensions that everyone had fled.[4]

Sri Kumar asked Malligai for the tracking team, along with a doctor and cyanide antidote kits. The local police were also alerted. The SIT had no jurisdictional authority to raid a place. Taking the help and permission of the local police was a must in India's federal structure. The tracking team arrived in an MI-8 chopper within hours. A meeting was held between the NSG's Ravindran and Sri Kumar's team at the VIP lounge of the Bangalore airport.[5]

The NSG Black Cats were trained in close-combat warfare. They were trained in storming hideouts of terrorists and capturing them alive, or rescuing victims held hostage by terrorists. The SIT knew Sivarasan was armed with an AK-47 assault rifle and a 9-mm pistol. Just like the INT group, the political group also had its stock of cyanide capsules, and arms and explosives, as was evident from the recent raids in Coimbatore, Salem and Trichy. In addition, Suthenthiraraja and Vijayan had disclosed earlier during interrogation that one of the three—Sivarasan, Neru or Shubha—would always be awake and armed to counter any attack on their hideout.[6]

In the meeting, Sri Kumar shared a piece of intelligence to help the tracking team understand how alert their target could be. After shutting down Sivarasan's wireless set, Pottu Amman was sending him messages through Trichy and others. An insider from the LTTE had brought to the